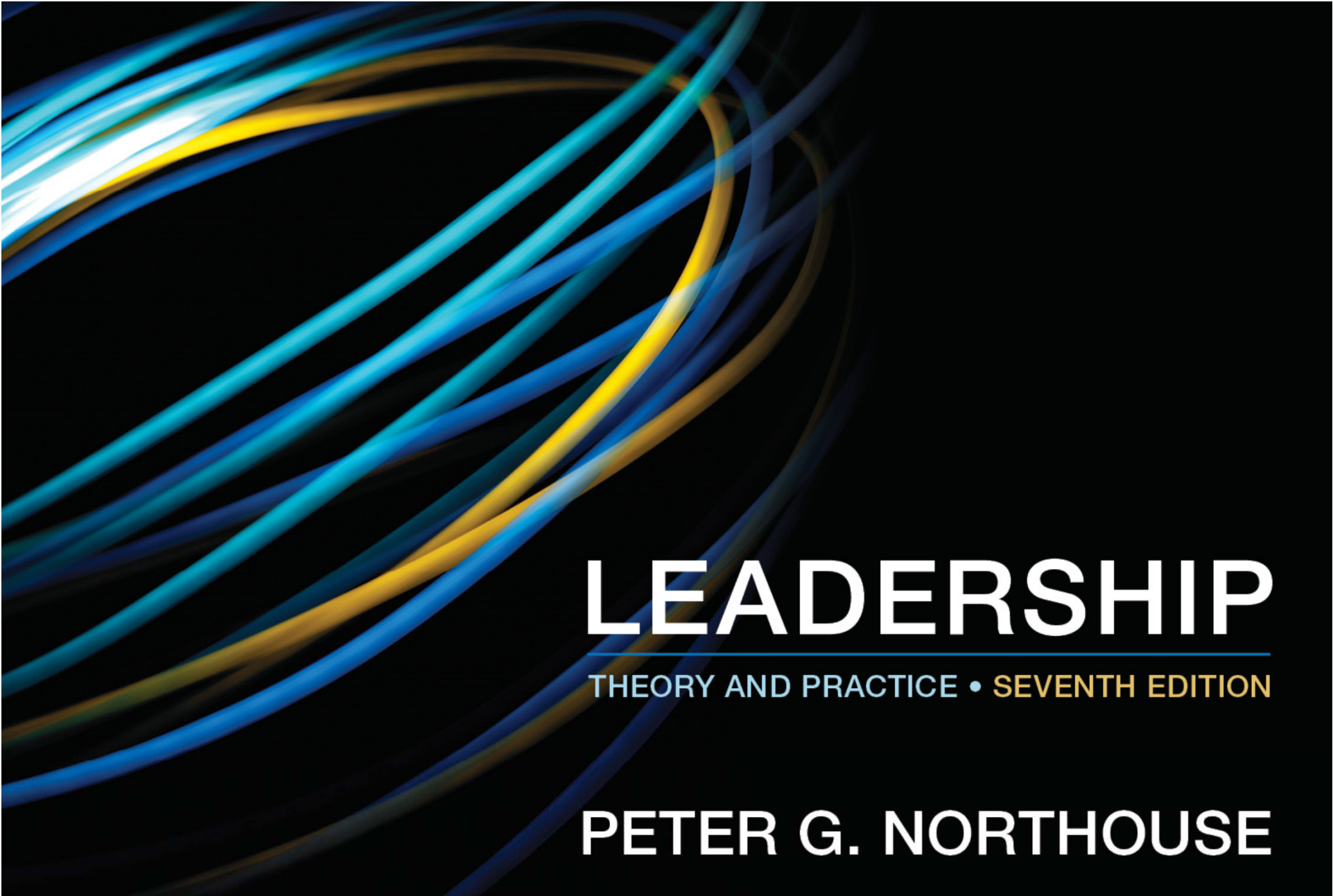




LEADERSHIP

THEORY AND PRACTICE • SEVENTH EDITION

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Chapter 4: Behavioral Approach

Overview

- ✦ Behavioral Approach Perspective
- ✦ Ohio State Studies
- ✦ University of Michigan Studies
- ✦ Blake & Mouton's Leadership Grid
- ✦ How Does the Style Approach Work?

Behavioral Approach Description

Perspective

- ✦ Emphasizes the **behavior** of the leader
- ✦ Focuses exclusively on what leaders do and how they act

Definition

- ✦ Composed of two general kinds of Behaviors
 - ◆ **Task behaviors**
Facilitate goal accomplishment:
Help group members achieve objectives
 - ◆ **Relationship behaviors**
Help subordinates feel comfortable with themselves, each other, and the situation

Ohio State Studies

- ✦ **Leadership Behavior Description Questionnaire (LBDQ)**
 - ◆ Identify number of times leaders engaged in specific behaviors
 - 150 questions
 - ◆ Participant settings (military, industrial, educational)
 - ◆ Results
 - Particular clusters of behaviors were typical of leaders

Ohio State Studies, cont'd.

✦ **LBDQ-XII (Stogdill, 1963)**

- ◆ Shortened version of the LBDQ
- ◆ Most widely used leadership assessment instrument
- ◆ Results - Two general types of leader behaviors:
 - **Initiating structure – Leaders provide structure for subordinates**
 - **Task behaviors** - organizing work, giving structure to the work context, defining role responsibility, scheduling work activities
 - **Consideration - Leaders nurture subordinates**
 - **Relationship behaviors** – building camaraderie, respect, trust, & liking between leaders & followers

University of Michigan Studies

- ✦ **Exploring leadership behavior**
 - ◆ Specific emphasis on impact of leadership behavior on performance of small groups
- ✦ **Results - Two types of leadership behaviors conceptualized as opposite ends of a single continuum**
 - ◆ **Employee orientation**
 - Strong human relations emphasis
 - ◆ **Production orientation**
 - Stresses the technical aspects of a job
 - ◆ Later studies reconceptualized behaviors as two independent leadership orientations - possible orientation to both at the same time

Blake & Mouton's Grid

✦ **Historical Perspective**

✦ **Leadership Grid Components**

- ◆ Authority-Compliance (9,1)
- ◆ Country Club Management (1,9)
- ◆ Impoverished Management (1,1)
- ◆ Middle-of-the-Road Management (5,5)
- ◆ Team Management (9,9)
- ◆ Paternalism/Maternalism (1,9; 9,1)
- ◆ Opportunism

Historical Perspective

Blake & Mouton's Managerial Leadership Grid

Development

- ✦ Developed in early 1960s
- ✦ Used extensively in organizational training & development

Purpose

- ✦ **Designed to explain how leaders help organizations to reach their purposes**
 - ◆ **Two factors**
 - **Concern for production**
 - How a leader is concerned with achieving **organizational tasks**
 - **Concern for people**
 - How a leader attends to the members of the organization who are trying to achieve its goals

Authority-Compliance (9,1)

Definition

- ✦ Efficiency in operations results from arranging conditions of work such that human interference is minimal

Role Focus

- ✦ **Heavy** emphasis on task and job requirements and *less* emphasis on people
- ✦ Communicating with subordinates mainly for task instructions
- ✦ **Results driven** – people regarded as tools to that end
- ✦ **9,1 leaders** – seen as controlling, demanding, hard-driving, & overpowering

Country Club (1,9)

Definition

- ✦ Thoughtful attention to the needs of people leads to a comfortable, friendly organizational atmosphere and work tempo

Role Focus

- ✦ **Low** concern for task accomplishment coupled with **high** concern for interpersonal relationships
- ✦ **Deemphasizes production;** leaders stress the attitudes and feelings of people
- ✦ **1,9 leaders** – try to create a positive climate by being agreeable, eager to help, comforting, noncontroversial

Impoverished (1,1)

Definition

- ✦ Minimal effort exerted to get work done is appropriate to sustain organizational membership

Role Focus

- ✦ Leader ***unconcerned*** with *both* task and interpersonal relationships
- ✦ Going through the motions, but **uninvolved** and withdrawn
- ✦ **1,1 leaders** – have little contact with followers and are described as indifferent, noncommittal, resigned, and apathetic

Middle-of-the-Road (5,5)

Definition

- ✦ Adequate organizational performance possible through balancing the necessity of getting work done while maintaining satisfactory morale

Role Focus

- ✦ **Leaders who are compromisers; have *intermediate* concern for task and people who do task**
- ✦ To achieve equilibrium, leader avoids conflict while emphasizing moderate levels of production and interpersonal relationships
- ✦ ***5,5 leader*** – described as expedient; prefers the middle ground; soft-pedals disagreement; swallows convictions in the interest of “progress”

Team (9,9)

Definition

- ✦ Work accomplished through committed people; interdependence via a “common stake” in the organization’s purpose, which leads to relationships of trust and respect

Role Focus

- ✦ **Strong emphasis on *both* tasks and interpersonal relationships**
- ✦ Promotes high degree of participation & teamwork, satisfies basic need of employee to be involved & committed to their work
- ✦ **9,9 leader** – stimulates participation, acts determined, makes priorities clear, follows through, behaves open-mindedly and enjoys working

Paternalism / Maternalism

Definition

- ✦ Reward and approval are bestowed on people in return for loyalty and obedience; failure to comply leads to punishment

Role Focus

- ✦ Leaders who use *both* 1,9 and 9,1 *without integrating* the two
- ✦ The “*benevolent dictator*”; acts gracious for purpose of goal accomplishment
- ✦ Treats people as though they were disassociated from the task
- ✦ Regards the organization as a family
- ✦ Makes most of the key decisions
- ✦ Rewards loyalty and punishes non-compliance

Opportunism

Definition

- ✦ People adapt and shift to any grid style needed to gain maximum advantage

Leaders usually have a **dominant** grid style used in most situations and a *backup* style that is reverted to when under pressure

Role Focus

- ✦ Performance occurs according to a system of selfish gain
- ✦ Leader uses any **combination** of the basic five styles for the purpose of personal advancement
- ✦ May be seen as ruthless and cunning
- ✦ May also be seen as adaptable and strategic

How Does the Behavioral Approach Work?

- ✦ Focus of Behavioral Approach
- ✦ Strengths
- ✦ Criticisms
- ✦ Application

Behavioral Approach

Focus

- ✦ Primarily a framework for assessing leadership as behavior with a task and relationship dimension

Overall Scope

- ✦ Offers a general means of assessing the behaviors of leaders

Strengths

- ✦ Behavioral approach marked a ***major shift*** in leadership research from exclusively trait focused to include behaviors and actions of leaders
- ✦ ***Broad range*** of studies on leadership style validates and gives credibility to the basic tenets of the approach
- ✦ At conceptual level, a leader's style is composed of two major types of behaviors: ***task and relationship***
- ✦ The behavioral approach is heuristic—leaders can learn a lot about themselves and how they come across to others by trying to see their behaviors in light of the task and relationship dimensions

Criticisms

- ✦ Research has ***not*** adequately demonstrated how leaders' styles are associated with performance outcomes
- ✦ ***No universal*** style of leadership that could be effective in almost every situation
- ✦ Implies that the most effective leadership style is ***High-High*** style (i.e., high task/high relationship); research finding support is limited

Application

- ✦ Many leadership training and development programs are designed along the lines of the style approach.
- ✦ By assessing their own style, managers can determine how they are perceived by others and how they could change their behaviors to become more effective.
- ✦ The style approach applies to nearly everything a leader does.